qae_european: how to use the kit

Status: version 1.0.0, ready for independent review (2026-11-10). Not yet signed off.

Prices a European call under Black-Scholes with **maximum-likelihood amplitude estimation** (MLAE) on a quantum circuit simulator, and compares it with Black-Scholes, Monte Carlo and quasi-Monte Carlo.

It is the simplest circuit we could build that still exercises the full amplitude-estimation method. A European call has a closed form, so this kit is not a case for using a quantum computer to price one: it is a test bench for the method, its benchmarks and its validation.

Document	Content	Status
This guide	Install, run, reproduce, extend	Current
Document 1: Circuit	The circuit, environment, inputs, outputs, reproducibility	Written
Document 2: Benchmarks	The comparators, why they were chosen, their code and parameters	Written
Document 3: Tests	Pre-registered test plan (Part 1), results and verdicts (Part 2)	Written

The documents are also exported to Word, LaTeX and PDF in `docs/export/` To rebuild them: `python docs/build_benchmarks_doc.py` in the kit folder, then `python tools/export/export_docs.py kits/qae_european` from the repository root. This needs pandoc, XeLaTeX (TeX Live with fontspec and sectsty) and the DejaVu fonts.

Earlier exploratory documents are kept in `docs/archive/` for the record. They describe a previous version of the code and are superseded.

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1. Install

Python 3.10 or later (tested on 3.13).

To reproduce the published results exactly, use the frozen environment:

```
git clone https://github.com/romaindutrenois-gif/veqctor-quantum.git
cd veqctor-quantum/kits/qae_european
python -m venv .venv && source .venv/bin/activate
pip install -r requirements-lock.txt
pip install --no-deps -e .
```

To use the kit in your own environment (versions within the ranges in `pyproject.toml`):

```
pip install -e ".[test]"
```

Check the install:

```
pytest tests          # 22 unit tests, a few seconds
```

No account or quantum hardware is needed: everything runs on a local simulator.

2. Price one option

```
qae-european price --spot 100 --strike 105 --rate 0.03 --vol 0.2 --maturity 1 --qubits 5 --depth 8
 ↪  --seed 1
```

Output in the frozen environment (rounded here to 5 decimals; the command prints full precision):

```
{
  "black_scholes": 7.12806,
  "grid_price": 7.11203,
  "circuit_exact": 7.11203,
  "amplitude_estimation": 7.09878,
```

```
  "calls": 26200,
  "monte_carlo": {"value": 6.97917, "calls": 26200, "stderr": 0.07683},
  "quasi_monte_carlo": {"value": 7.12759, "calls": 16384, "stderr": null}
}
```

How to read it:

- `black_scholes` is the reference price.
- `grid_price` is the price on the discretised distribution (2^5 = 32 points). The gap to Black-Scholes is the **discretisation bias**; it shrinks as `--qubits` grows.
- `circuit_exact` is the price read from the exact state of the circuit. It must equal `grid_price` up to numerical precision: this checks the circuit. The difference is below 10^{-13} at 5 qubits and up to a relative 10^{-8} at 7, from Qiskit's synthesis of the state preparation (Document 1, section 11).
- `amplitude_estimation` is one MLAE estimate using `calls` applications of the circuit A. Its error against `grid_price` is the **statistical error**.
- `monte_carlo` uses the same number of calls (paths). Quasi-Monte Carlo uses the largest power of two not above it (a Sobol requirement). Its `stderr` is not defined for a single scrambled sequence, hence `null`.

Options: `--qubits` (price qubits, 3 to 7 in the campaign; the circuit has `qubits + 1` qubits) and `--depth` (MLAE ladder: Grover powers 0, 1, 2, 4, ..., 2^(depth−2), 100 measurements each).

3. Use it from Python

```python
import numpy as np
from qae_european import Option, LognormalGrid, QuantumPricer, MaximumLikelihoodAE, Ladder,
 ↪  BlackScholes

option = Option(spot=100, strike=105, rate=0.03, vol=0.2, maturity=1.0)
grid = LognormalGrid(option, n_qubits=5)        # lognormal on 32 points, ±4 standard deviations
pricer = QuantumPricer(grid)                    # builds the circuits A and Q

print(pricer.circuit_a().draw())                # the circuit itself (Qiskit)
print(BlackScholes.call(option), grid.price(), pricer.price_exact())

ladder = Ladder.exponential(depth=8, shots=100)
mlae = MaximumLikelihoodAE(ladder, backend="statevector")   # simulates A Q^k in full
print(mlae.estimate_prices(pricer, np.random.default_rng(1), draws=5), ladder.calls)
```

Expected output (frozen environment), after a few seconds:

```
7.1280646692617395 7.1120286452832895 7.112028645283094
[7.09877631 7.14967104 7.09960548 7.12204347 7.11001134] 26200
```

The first estimate is the same as the `amplitude_estimation` value of section 2: same seed, and the two backends give the same probabilities.

Two backends give the same measurement probabilities on a noise-free simulator:

- `"statevector"` simulates every circuit A Q^k with Qiskit. Exact, slow for large powers.
- `"born"` uses the identity P(1 after k steps) = $\sin^2((2k + 1)\theta)$, with θ from the exact state of A. Fast; used for the campaign. The identity is checked by `qae-european verify` and by the unit tests.

4. Run the test campaign

```
qae-european verify                          # H0-b: full simulation of A Q^k on 20 random scenarios,
 ↪  about 12 minutes
qae-european campaign --processes 2          # 1,848 scenarios; measured: about 25 minutes on 2 cores
```

Outputs go to `results/verification.json`, `results/campaign.csv` (one row per scenario, number of qubits and budget; columns described at the top of `src/qae_european/campaign.py`) and

`results/run_info.json` (the commit, parameters and library versions of the run). The published results are in the repository.

To check them against the criteria of Document 3 and redraw its figures (needs the docs extra, `pip install -e ".[docs]"`):

```
python docs/analyse.py                    # writes results/summary.json and docs/img/*.png
python docs/checks.py                     # writes results/checks.json (state-preparation accuracy,
 ↪  MLAE global maximum)
```

The campaign is **resumable**: scenarios already in the CSV are skipped. To split it, use `--start` and `--stop` (scenario indices, 0 to 1,848).

5. Reproduce a single row

Every random stream is derived from a fixed seed (20261103) and the indices of the scenario, qubits, budget and method. Any row can be recomputed on its own:

```python
from qae_european.campaign import scenarios, run_scenario

sc = scenarios()[1000]                    # moneyness 1.0, maturity 5Y, vol 60%, rate 0%
row = run_scenario(sc, qubits=(5,), depths=(8,))[0]
print(row)
```

The values must match the row of `results/campaign.csv` with the same `scenario`, `qubits` and `depth`, exactly, in the frozen environment.

6. Code layout

```
src/qae_european/
  option.py              Option: contract and market inputs, with validation
  grid.py               LognormalGrid: discretisation on 2^n points (conditional-
mean prices)
  quantum.py         QuantumPricer: circuit A, Grover operator Q, exact probabilities
  estimation.py           Ladder, MaximumLikelihoodAE
  benchmarks/         BlackScholes, MonteCarlo (continuous or on the grid), QuasiMonteCarlo (scr
  resources.py           circuit size after compilation, power-law fits
  campaign.py            the scenario grid, the runner, the verification
  cli.py                 the qae-european command
tests/test_package.py    unit tests
docs/              Documents 1 to 3, figures (make_figures.py), analysis (analyse.py), exports
results/            the published campaign: campaign.csv, verification.json, run_info.json, su
```

7. Adapt it to another payoff

The circuit loads a distribution on n qubits, then rotates an objective qubit by the normalised payoff at each grid point. To price another payoff on the same underlying, change the payoff:

1. Subclass `Option` and override `payoff`. Everything else (`LognormalGrid`, `QuantumPricer`, `MonteCarlo`, `QuasiMonteCarlo`) calls `option.payoff`, so it follows. For a put:

   ```python
   from dataclasses import dataclass
   import numpy as np
   from qae_european import Option, LognormalGrid, QuantumPricer, MonteCarlo

   @dataclass(frozen=True)
   class Put(Option):
       def payoff(self, prices):
           return np.maximum(self.strike - np.asarray(prices, dtype=float), 0.0)

   put = Put(spot=100, strike=95, rate=0.03, vol=0.2, maturity=1.0)
   ```

```
print(QuantumPricer(LognormalGrid(put, 5)).price_exact())                    # 4.3594 on the grid
print(MonteCarlo().price(put, 200_000, np.random.default_rng(0)).value)      # 4.3797;
 ↪  Black-Scholes put: 4.3720
```

2. `QuantumPricer` normalises the grid payoffs by their maximum and sets one rotation per point. It needs no change as long as payoffs are non-negative.
3. `BlackScholes` prices calls only. Add the closed form of the new payoff, if there is one, as a benchmark (subclass `Benchmark`), and the campaign code will run against it once `campaign.run_scenario` calls it.

Path-dependent payoffs (Asian, barrier) need more qubits per time step and are outside this kit.

8. Limits

- **Simulator only, no noise.** No run on real hardware.
- **Exact loading does not scale.** State preparation and one controlled rotation per grid point both grow exponentially with the number of qubits. Practical pricers need efficient loading, still an open problem.
- **Calls are not run time.** One call of A on a fault-tolerant machine is far slower than one Monte Carlo path on a GPU. The comparison is in number of calls only (see Document 3, section 1.1).
- **Error is scaled by the largest payoff.** The price is read as discount × largest payoff × amplitude, so for wide grids (high volatility, long maturity) a small amplitude error becomes a large price error.

References

- Suzuki et al., *Amplitude estimation without phase estimation*, Quantum Information Processing, 2020. arXiv:1904.10246
- Stamatopoulos et al., *Option pricing using quantum computers*, Quantum, 2020. arXiv:1905.02666
- Chakrabarti et al., *A threshold for quantum advantage in derivative pricing*, Quantum, 2021. arXiv:2012.03819
- Stamatopoulos and Zeng, *Derivative pricing using quantum signal processing*, Quantum, 2024. arXiv:2307.14310